

Logos 聚会

2026-07-25

使徒行传 9:1 - 19

关键成果

本次查经聚焦使徒行传第 9 章,探讨扫罗戏剧性的归信——

这是新约中最重要的事件之一。小组探讨了关键神学主题,包括上帝拣选罪人的主权恩典、通过谦卑实现属灵转变的本质,以及普通信徒在上帝使命中的角色。随后进行了两次深入的问答讨论

——
一次探讨为何上帝不对现代逼迫基督徒的人采取类似干预,另一次讨论父母对子女信仰的焦虑。

经文诵读与段落概览

- **第 1-8 节:** 扫罗在前往大马士革的路上与基督相遇——
强光照耀、仆倒在地、听见耶稣的声音。
- **第 9 节:** 三天失明、禁食和祷告。
- **第 10-14 节:**
上帝在异象中指示亚拿尼亚去探访扫罗;亚拿尼亚表达了对扫罗作为逼迫者名声的担忧。
- **第 15-19 节:**
上帝宣告扫罗是祂“所拣选的器皿”;亚拿尼亚为扫罗按手,恢复他的视力;扫罗受洗。

核心教导:扫罗归信前的品格

- 扫罗不是中立的怀疑者,而是教会的积极、暴力的敌人——
口吐威吓凶杀的话,寻求逮捕和摧毁基督徒群体。
- 他的逼迫从耶路撒冷延伸到大马士革(现今叙利亚首都),超过 200 英里,显示出他敌意的强度。
- 他绝对确信自己的自以为义——
相信自己在捍卫上帝的事业,作为法利赛人认为自己优于罪人和税吏。
- 他归信前的祷告反映了这种骄傲:感谢上帝让自己比别人更好,而不是谦卑地寻求怜悯。
- 他相信耶稣是假弥赛亚,所有基督徒都被欺骗了。

核心教导:扫罗归信的本质

上帝的主权主动(恩典)

- 扫罗并没有寻找耶稣——
是耶稣来到扫罗面前,这清楚地展示了上帝的恩典,而非人的寻求。
- 保罗后来在罗马书中写道"当我们还作罪人的时候,上帝就爱我们"——
他自己的归信就是这一原则的活生生证明。
- 没有人选择上帝;是上帝拣选我们——即使在我们悖逆和抵抗的时候。
- 扫罗的归信被认为是**罕见和神迹性的**——不是人们归信的典型方式。

羞辱作为转变

- 在相遇之前,扫罗骄傲自信;之后,他**失明并依赖他人**牵着他的手——
这是对他骄傲的刻意打破。
- 三天的失明具有**象征意义**:与基督在坟墓中的三天平行,代表新生命之前的一种死亡。
- 自我必须死去,信仰中的新生命才能开始;上帝使用羞辱来打破人的骄傲,这是转变的必要步骤。
- 在遇见基督后,扫罗的**祷告**完全改变了——
从自以为义的宣告变为**谦卑地寻求上帝的怜悯**,认识到自己的罪性。

耶稣与教会的认同

- 耶稣没有说"你为什么逼迫**我的百姓**?",而是说"你为什么逼迫**我**?"——
表明基督直接认同于教会。
- 逼迫基督徒等同于攻击基督本身;教会与基督是合一的。

核心教导:亚拿尼亚——被上帝使用的普通信徒

- 亚拿尼亚被简单地描述为"**一个门徒**"——不是使徒,不是著名领袖,只是一个普通信徒。
- 尽管扫罗是整个新约中最重要的人物之一,上帝却选择了一个**不为人知的普通人**作为他恢复的器皿。
- 关键原则:上帝不仅使用有权势或著名的人——
任何忠心的信徒只要顺服就能被上帝使用。

诚实的信心——向上帝表达恐惧

- 亚拿尼亚没有盲目顺从;他向上帝**表达了对扫罗危险名声的真实担忧**。

- 这展示了一个重要真理:**信心并不意味着没有恐惧**——而是**尽管恐惧仍然顺服上帝**。
- 鼓励信徒诚实地将所有恐惧和担忧带到上帝面前,祂会看见并帮助。

上帝的同步预备

- 上帝**同时预备了亚拿尼亚和扫罗**:给扫罗一个异象,看见亚拿尼亚来医治他,同时指示亚拿尼亚前去。
- 这展示了上帝在协调转变过程中详细、协调的护理。

核心教导:扫罗作为上帝所拣选的器皿

- 上帝宣告扫罗是**"我所拣选的器皿"**——
表明这一拣选发生在扫罗转变**之前**,甚至在他逼迫教会的时候。
- 扫罗的资质使他非常适合:对圣经的深刻了解、犹太血统、罗马公民身份(提供行动自由)、教育和才华——但他的**方向错了**。
- 上帝**没有**在扫罗身上创造新的品质;祂**重新引导现有的品质**去向外邦人、君王和以色列传福音。
- 上帝还预言扫罗将为基督的名**受许多苦**——监禁、鞭打、石击、拒绝——
直接反驳了上帝的呼召保证舒适和成功的假设。

核心教导:恢复、弟兄情谊和洗礼

- 当亚拿尼亚问候扫罗时,他称他为**"兄弟扫罗"**——
尽管他们曾是敌人,但立即接纳他为同信的弟兄。
- 这展示了福音的**和解能力**,不仅在人与上帝之间,也在人与人之间——
曾经的敌人成为弟兄姐妹。
- 从扫罗眼睛上掉下来的鳞片具有**象征意义**:他的肉体视力恢复代表他属灵的眼睛**打开**——
从属灵的瞎眼到看见真理。
- 这呼应了赞美诗《奇异恩典》:"我曾瞎眼,今得看见"——
这是所有信徒共同的经历,不仅是扫罗。
- 扫罗的**洗礼**公开认同基督的死、埋葬和复活,正式完成了他的归信。

问答:为何上帝不对现代逼迫者采取干预?

问题(鹿):

如果上帝在扫罗逼迫教会时改变了他,为什么上帝不对今天逼迫基督徒的人做同样的事——在中国、埃塞俄比亚或中东?

回应(LJM):

- 上帝今天 **确实**仍在改变逼迫者——
有许多像扫罗一样归信的人,包括官员和穆斯林,尽管通过不同且不那么戏剧性的方式。
- **早期教会独特的历史背景**解释了为何扫罗的归信如此戏剧性:
 - 新约尚未写成;四福音书和保罗的书信不完整或未写成。
 - 早期教会**没有圣经**,没有稳固的教义——完全依赖使徒的口头教导和权威。
 - 使徒权威在当时比今天重要得多;摧毁一个使徒对整个教会有灾难性后果。
- 今天,信徒拥有**完整的圣经**、记录的教导和全球基督教资源——
对个别使徒的结构性依赖不再存在。
- 扫罗归信的戏剧性、神迹性本质**适合教会历史那个创立时刻的独特需要**。

问答:父母对子女信仰的焦虑

问题(鹿):

引用旧约例子(亚伦的儿子拿答和亚比户、大卫和所罗门),她表达了对大学年龄子女的深切焦虑,他们年幼时参加教会,但现在持怀疑态度——只有在上帝给他们实际好处时才愿意相信。

回应(LJM):

信仰是个人的,不能继承

- 旧约模式反复显示**信仰不能通过家族血统传承**——父辈忠心,子辈离弃。
- 救恩是**与上帝的个人关系**,不由家庭背景或父母的信仰决定。
- 每个人必须建立自己与上帝的直接关系——这不能继承。

父母的责任

- 父母必须首先**自己成为好基督徒**——
子女问题的根源往往在于父母的行为、错误的榜样或不良的关系模式。
- 成为好榜样是首要和最有力的工具:子女观察父母,真实信仰的生活自然会影响他们。
- 信仰必须在**纵向**(与上帝)和**横向**(与邻舍、朋友、子女)两方面活出来——
忽视关系的不平衡信仰是不完整的。

关系重于表现

- 父母必须**无条件地爱子女**,不基于他们的表现或信仰状态——根据子女的行为评判他们会损害关系。
- 当子女感受到父母**真正的尊重和尊荣**时,他们**更自然地倾向于尊重**父母的信仰,并随着时间推移效法他们的榜样。
- 福音的和解适用于家庭内部:父母和子女必须彼此**饶恕和和解**,不仅与上帝和解。

盼望与耐心

- **永远不会太晚**——保罗本人是成年人,已经深深确立了对上帝的反对,却仍被转变。
- 大学年龄**离开信仰**的子女往往是在发展独立性的过程中这样做;**维持关系比控制更重要**。
- 父母应该尽力而为,树立好榜样,**将结果交托给上帝**而不是过度焦虑——
鹿自己的结论也肯定了这一方法。

Logos Meeting

2026-07-25

Acts 9:1 - 19

Key Outcomes

This Bible study session focused on Acts Chapter 9, examining Saul's dramatic conversion as one of the most significant events in the New Testament. The group explored key theological themes including God's sovereign grace in choosing sinners, the nature of spiritual transformation through humility, and the role of ordinary believers in God's mission. Two substantive Q&A discussions followed — one addressing why God does not intervene similarly for modern persecutors of Christians, and another on parental anxiety over children's faith.

Scripture Reading & Passage Overview

- **Verses 1–8:** Saul's encounter with Christ on the road to Damascus — blinding light, falling to the ground, hearing Jesus' voice.
 - **Verses 9:** Three days of blindness, fasting, and prayer.
 - **Verses 10–14:** God's vision to Ananias instructing him to visit Saul; Ananias expresses concern about Saul's reputation as a persecutor.
 - **Verses 15–19:** God declares Saul His "chosen instrument"; Ananias lays hands on Saul, restoring his sight; Saul is baptized.
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Core Teaching: Saul's Character Before Conversion

- Saul was not a neutral skeptic but an **active, violent enemy of the church** — breathing threats, seeking to arrest and destroy Christian communities.
- His persecution extended beyond Jerusalem into Damascus (modern-day capital of Syria), over 200 miles away, demonstrating the intensity of his hostility.
- He was absolutely convinced of his own **self-righteousness** — believing he was defending God's cause, acting as a Pharisee who considered himself superior to sinners and tax collectors.

- His pre-conversion prayer reflected this pride: thanking God for being better than others rather than humbly seeking mercy.
- He believed Jesus was a **false messiah** and that all Christians had been deceived.

Core Teaching: The Nature of Saul's Conversion

God's Sovereign Initiative (Grace)

- Saul was not searching for Jesus — **Jesus came to Saul**, making this a clear demonstration of God's grace, not human seeking.
- Paul later wrote in Romans that "God loved us while we are still sinners" — his own conversion was the living proof of this principle.
- No one chooses God; God chooses us — even while we are disobedient and resistant.
- Saul's conversion was acknowledged as **rare and miraculous** — not the typical manner in which people come to faith.

Humiliation as Transformation

- Before the encounter, Saul was proud and self-assured; afterward, he was **struck blind and dependent on others** to lead him by the hand — a deliberate breaking of his pride.
- The three days of blindness carry **symbolic weight**: paralleling Christ's three days in the tomb, representing a kind of death before new life.
- The self must die before a new life in faith can begin; God uses humiliation to break human pride as a necessary step in transformation.
- After encountering Christ, Saul's prayer changed completely — from self-righteous declaration to **humble seeking of God's mercy**, recognizing his own sinfulness.

Jesus' Identification with the Church

- Jesus did not say "Why do you persecute *my people*?" but rather "**Why do you persecute me?**" — indicating that Christ identifies himself directly with the church.
- Persecuting Christians is equivalent to attacking Christ himself; the church and Christ are unified.

Core Teaching: Ananias — The Ordinary Believer Used by God

- Ananias is described simply as "**a disciple**" — not an apostle, not a famous leader, just an ordinary believer.
- Despite Saul being one of the most consequential figures in the entire New Testament, God chose an **unknown, ordinary person** to be the instrument of his restoration.
- Key principle: God does not only use powerful or famous people — **any faithful believer can be used by God** when they are simply obedient.

Honest Faith — Expressing Fear to God

- Ananias did not blindly comply; he **expressed his genuine concern** about Saul's dangerous reputation to God.
- This models an important truth: **faith does not mean the absence of fear** — it means obeying God *despite* fear.
- Believers are encouraged to bring all fears and concerns honestly to God, who will see and help.

God's Simultaneous Preparation

- God prepared **both Ananias and Saul at the same time**: giving Saul a vision of Ananias coming to heal him, while directing Ananias to go.
- This demonstrates God's detailed, coordinated providence in orchestrating transformation.

Core Teaching: Saul as God's Chosen Instrument

- God declared Saul "my chosen instrument" — indicating this selection occurred **before** Saul's transformation, even while he was persecuting the church.
 - Saul's qualifications made him well-suited: deep knowledge of scripture, Jewish heritage, Roman citizenship (providing freedom of movement), education, and brilliance — but his **direction had been wrong**.
 - God did not create new qualities in Saul; He **redirected existing ones** toward spreading the gospel to Gentiles, kings, and Israel.
 - God also foretold that Saul would **suffer greatly** for Christ's name — imprisonment, beatings, stoning, rejection — directly countering the assumption that God's calling guarantees comfort and success.
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Core Teaching: Restoration, Brotherhood, and Baptism

- When Ananias greeted Saul, he called him "**Brother Saul**" — immediately accepting him as a fellow believer despite their history as enemies.
 - This models the gospel's power of **reconciliation not only between people and God, but between people themselves** — former enemies becoming brothers and sisters.
 - The scales falling from Saul's eyes carry **symbolic meaning**: his physical sight restored represents his spiritual eyes opening — moving from spiritual blindness to seeing the truth.
 - This mirrors the hymn *Amazing Grace*: "I once was blind, but now I see" — an experience shared by all believers, not just Saul.
 - Saul's **baptism** publicly identified him with Christ's death, burial, and resurrection, officially completing his conversion.
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Q&A: Why Doesn't God Intervene for Modern Persecutors?

Question (Lu): If God changed Saul while he was persecuting the church, why doesn't God do the same for those persecuting Christians today — in China, Ethiopia, or the Middle East?

Response (LJM):

- God *does* still change persecutors today — there are many people like Saul who come to faith, including officials and Muslims, though through different and less dramatic means.
- **The unique historical context of the early church** explains why Saul's conversion was so dramatic:
 - The New Testament was not yet written; the four Gospels and Paul's letters were incomplete or unwritten.
 - The early church had **no Bible**, no solid doctrines — it depended entirely on the oral teaching and authority of apostles.
 - Apostolic authority was far more critical then than today; destroying an apostle had catastrophic consequences for the entire church.
- Today, believers have **access to a complete Bible**, recorded teaching, and global Christian resources — the structural dependence on individual apostles no longer exists.
- The dramatic, miraculous nature of Saul's conversion was **appropriate to the unique needs of that founding moment** in church history.

Q&A: Parental Anxiety Over Children's Faith

Question (Lu): Drawing on Old Testament examples (Aaron's sons Nadab and Abihu, David and Solomon), she expressed deep anxiety about her college-aged children who attended church when young but now are skeptical — willing to believe only if God gives them tangible benefits.

Response (LJM):

Faith Is Personal, Not Inherited

- Old Testament patterns repeatedly show that **faith cannot be passed down through family lineage** — father's generation faithful, children's generation falling away.
- Salvation is a **personal relationship with God**, not determined by family background or parental faith.
- Each individual must build their own direct relationship with God — this cannot be inherited.

Parental Responsibility

- Parents must first **be good Christians themselves** — the source of children's problems is often found in parental behavior, wrong examples, or poor relational patterns.
- Being a good example is the primary and most powerful tool: children observe their parents, and a life of genuine faith naturally influences them.
- Faith must be lived both **vertically** (with God) and **horizontally** (with neighbors, friends, children) — an imbalanced faith that ignores relationships is incomplete.

Relationship Over Performance

- Parents must **love children unconditionally**, not based on their performance or belief status — judging children by their behavior damages the relationship.
- When children feel genuinely honored and respected by parents, they are **more naturally inclined** to honor their parents' faith and follow their example over time.
- Gospel reconciliation applies within families: parents and children must **forgive and reconcile** with each other, not only with God.

Hope and Patience

- It is **never too late** — Paul himself was an adult, already deeply established in opposition to God, when he was transformed.

- College-aged children who leave the faith often do so as part of developing independence; **relationship maintenance is more important than control** during this stage.
- Parents should do their best, set a good example, and **trust God with the outcome** rather than over-stressing — Lu's own conclusion affirmed this approach.